

Lee Sinclair

Technical Team Lead | Engineering Manager

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SUMMARY

Technology leader with 20+ years spanning software engineering, product ownership, and people leadership. Currently leads a team of nine engineers delivering a complex, long-lived platform within Australia's regulated lending environment. I have built team capability through structured mentorship, technical competency frameworks, and a strong documentation and testing culture, and is currently driving the team's adoption of AI-assisted engineering practices. Combines deep, current technical credibility across the stack with a leadership approach grounded in autonomy, mastery, and purpose by translating strategy into sustainable delivery outcomes.

CORE SKILLS

Technical Leadership & People Management · Engineering Governance & Standards · Delivery & Capacity Planning · Product Ownership · Technical Competency Frameworks · AI-Assisted Engineering & SDLC · Legacy System Modernisation · Workshop Facilitation & Training · Documentation & Testing Culture · CI/CD · Information Architecture · Usability & UX

Technical stack: Node.js, TypeScript, T-SQL, Bash, React

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Team Leader & Engineering Manager *Dec 2019 – Present (6 years 9 months)*

Credit Sense

Lead an engineering team of nine, responsible for the delivery, quality, and ongoing evolution of a complex, long-lived platform operating within a regulated lending environment. Own people, engineering practice, delivery, product, and technical governance for the team.

- Lead, mentor, and develop engineers through regular 1:1s, performance management, development planning, and structured technical competency frameworks.
- Own delivery planning, capacity management, prioritisation, risk management, and delivery accountability across the team.
- Establish coding and documentation standards, and engineering governance covering software quality, testing, observability, SDLC, and CI/CD.
- Facilitate internal workshops on engineering best practice, covering legacy system maintenance, logging, and AI-assisted SDLC, to lift team-wide capability.
- Guided the team through migrating legacy software components to a sustainable, maintainable state.
- Leading the team's adoption of AI-assisted engineering practices, including a structured onboarding program on agentic coding workflows and internal tooling for automated code review and test generation.
- Provide technical leadership and architectural oversight across the platform (Node.js/TypeScript, T-SQL, Bash, React), keeping engineering decisions aligned with product and organisational objectives.
- Partner across product, business, and technical stakeholders to translate strategic objectives into practical delivery outcomes.
- Served as Product Owner for six years, providing end-to-end ownership of a highly complex platform and driving improvements to performance, stability, resilience, and operational efficiency.
- Built team capability and distributed critical domain knowledge, transitioning the platform from reliance on individual technical expertise to sustainable team ownership.
- Established processes that improved delivery predictability, reduced technical and organisational risk, and enabled the team to operate with greater independence.

Product Manager *Oct 2018 – Dec 2019 (1 year 3 months)*

Kudos Knowledge

- Owned product design, analysis, customer engagement, and feature specification, including technical design and specification for AI and semantic analysis capability.
- Directed UX/UI design (web and mobile) and system architecture (AWS, Lambda, Kubernetes, bare-metal).
- Led rapid, high-reliability feature roll-out for a category-defining product, responding directly to customer and business needs while maintaining high auditability.

Consultant *Jan 2014 – Oct 2019 (5 years 10 months)*

MetaTheory

Independent consultancy delivering product strategy, UX, and technology leadership across client engagements, including two CTO placements (below). Worked across product strategy and management, UX/IA, AI, and software development.

CTO (client engagement via MetaTheory) *Jan 2016 – Oct 2018 (2 years 10 months)*

BETIA

- Owned strategic design, customer engagement, roadmaps, and infrastructure and database architecture; led technical design and specification including AI and semantic analysis.
- Directed infrastructure architecture (AWS, Lambda, Kubernetes, EC2) and UX/UI design across the product suite.
- Designed and delivered four industry-first products and led numerous successful product pivots.
- Improved system performance and maintainability while reducing costs; contributed to a 30% increase in trading profitability and a 500%+ increase in productive content output.

CTO (client engagement via MetaTheory) *Feb 2014 – Feb 2016 (2 years 1 month)*

newNRG Pty Ltd

- Led strategic technology planning to achieve business goals, prioritising development initiatives and setting timetables for the evaluation, development, and deployment of all technology services.

EARLIER CAREER

Product Director — Kudos Knowledge *Dec 2010 – Dec 2013*

Architected and delivered ground-breaking AI-driven products addressing information overwhelm, scaling to 864,000+ transactions and 100,000+ unique visitors per day (MongoDB, Node.js).

Product Director — Netcat Pty Ltd *Jan 2007 – Dec 2010*

Set long-term product strategy and usability direction, introduced standards compliance, delivered training programs, and led delivery of numerous client websites.

User Experience Architect — PhunQube *Jan 2006 – Jun 2006*

Designed banking and media products, including the 4oD product for Channel 4, winner of Best New Media Product 2006 (UK).

EDUCATION

Graduate Certificate of eBusiness — University of Southern Queensland (2004)

Bachelor of Business — University of Southern Queensland (1997)